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LITHOGRAPHS
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MARIGOLD
GALLERY

ONE OF THE TWO SCULPTURES BY ARTIST ANISH KAPOOR WAS SOLD TO A FAMILY OF INDIAN COLLECTORS FOR RS 1.5 CRORE.

British artist Julian Opie. Big names like Chittrovanu Mazumdar, Atul and Anju Dodiya besides Jitish and Reena Kallat, Subodh Gupta, Andy Warhol and masters like Jamini Roy, Pablo Picasso and Salvador Dali. The summit sold some 250 works of art valued at approximately Rs 26 crore, a huge jump from last year.

This year, the summit proved that

Second Coming

A comparison tells the story

2008	2009
10,000 visitors	40,000 visitors
34 galleries	54 galleries
Rs 10 crore sales	Rs 26 crore sales

the art scene in India has grown both in stature and reputation. Comparisons are inevitable and while the summit must be given credit for raising the bar from the standards set last year, it still fails to measure up to international standards in terms of infrastructure and planning. "I would say it's halfway there and it's only in its second year," views Dr Premilla Baid of Sumukha Gallery from Bangalore. At the end of the day, the sight of thousands of students, housewives and even children

thronging the venue and looking at works they've never seen before is probably every artist's dream come true: Art made accessible to the public. Said a visibly excited Vibha Rao gaping at Gupta's Three Monkeys installation in bronze: "I have seen his works in magazines, but this is the first time I'm within touching distance of both the artist and the work." Other artists like Mazumdar, Menon, Vivan Sundaram, Jatin Das and several more were freely accessible. As Yvonna Veiherter from the Ivonna Art Gallery of Latvia remarked: "I have never seen so many people at any art fair. We have not made a single sale, but we ran out of brochures and visiting cards on day one. This interest is enough to bring us back." And with over 20 galleries confirming their entry for next year before the conclusion of this summit, one can safely predict that the Indian Art Summit can call itself a truly global art event. ■

CITIZEN BY SUBBA GHOSH

